The class of 2018 U19 World Cup



Intro:

Generational !
Agar aap koi bhi sport consume karte ho toh aapne kai baar fans ko kafi jyada talented players ko is “Generational” ka tag dete hue suna hi hoga. Phir chahe woh unka favourite player ho , ya phir ek aisa player jo ki kaafi kam samay pe kafi kuch achieve kar chuka ho us sports mein. And baaki saare sports ki tarah , yeh baat ham sabke ke favourite sports CRICKET mein bhi lagu hoti hai .Cricket mein koi bhi International team kitna dominate karegi, kitni legacy banaegi, ya phir kitni glory achieve karegi, yeh baat na toh Players ke experience pe solely depend karti hai, aur na hi us team ka environement kaisa hai. But jis cheez pe dominance sabse jyada depend karti hai, woh hai “The Amount of Generational Players that the team has” !
Aur agar hum baat kare aaj ki Team India ki , toh the list goes on and on.....*[Pics of Kohli , Pujara , Rahane , Rohit]*
Pichle 25 saalo mein jitne generational talents team India se nikle hai utne shayad hi kisi aur desh se nikle ho. Virat Kohli , Mohammed Kaif , Rohit Sharma , Shikhar Dhawan , Ishant Sharma are the examples. But kya ho ki mein aapse kahu ki in sabhi generational talents mein ek cheej common thi. Yeh sabhi players Indian team mein apne U19 world cup ke performance ki

vajah se hue the. Unhone jitna tagda u19 wc mein perform kara, main team mein select ho jane ke baad vaisa hi performance zaari rakha. Is system se India ne kafi jyada players nikale hai, phir chahe woh 2000 U19 WC ke youngsters ho, ya phir 2008 U19 WC ke. But the truth is, no world cup youngsters come close to the "Class of 2018" !

Chapter 0

Ab maano ya na maano , jitna talent hume 2018 ke U19 world cup mein dekhne ko mila tha, utna shayad hi hame kisi aur U19 world cup mein dekhne ko mila ho. That world cup was not only special but hamari generation mein woh ek lauta world cup tha jisse India mein U19 cricket ko lekar craze badha tha. Jabse U19 world cups cricket history mein shuru hue hai, tabse lekar ab tak hame har world cup se 1-2 talented players dekhne ko mil hi jaate hai. Phir chahe woh 2000 ke world cup ke Yuvraj Singh , 2004 U19 world cup se Shikhar Dhawan aur ya phir 2008 ke U19 world cup se khud King Kohli ho. But 2018 ke U19 world cup se, there was not only one or two players , it was the whole team ! Shubman Gill se lekar Abhishek Sharma tak , sabhi ke sabhi players us team mein na hi keval talented the, balki jis hisab se un players ne us world cup mein one sided dominate kara tha, aisa lag hi nahi raha tha ki woh team koi competition bhi face kar rahi hai. Pichle 2-3 saalo mein jaha pe ek taraf team India har format mein kafi achcha kar rahi hai, vahi pe Shubman Gill , Abhishek sharma aur Arshdeep singh (jo ki 2018 wc batch ka part the) iska reason bataye jaate hai. Lekin us 2018 U19 WC ki Iconic Team India ko Iconic banane ki shuruaat 2017 se hi ho chuki thi, under the "WALL OF INDIA" .

CHAPTER 1 — The Rahul Dravid Factor

14 February 2016, India 2016 ka U19 world cup ek humiliating way mein West Indies se haar jati hai. Pure tournament ko dominate karne ke baad India falls short against the mighty west Indians. But isme shocking baat yeh hai ki is final mein bhi kai Indian talents part le rahe the. Jaise Rishabh Pant , Khud Captain Ishan Kishan aur Sarfaraz Khan, But itne sab talented khiladi hone ke bawajood West Indies tear apart India aur 5 wicket se woh final and woh world cup apne naam kar leti hai. Us Loss se na keval BCCI ko ek bada jhatka lagta hai balki unhe bhi samajh saata hai ki U19 world cups keval ek trophy

hunt tournament nahi hai. Lekin ek aisa stage hai jaha pe young Indian prodijies se best nikalwake India ko ek upcoming superstar de sakte hai. Aur yaha pe entry hoti hai us insaan ki jo ki na keval India ko unki history ke best youngsters dene wala tha balki us puri U19 team mein ek aisi philosophy jaari karne wala tha jaha pe India ka future aur bhi jyada bright hone wala tha.....

Rahul Dravid !
508 International Matches 24 hazar se jyada international runs aur 48 shatak ! Dravid na keval India ke one of the best players mein se jo already India ko kai baar match jitwa chuke hai , balki woh India ke one of the most experienced player bhi hai. Toh in young bloods ko train karni ki zimedaari ab bhala Rahul Dravid se better kon kar sakta tha.

Aur yahi pe aati hai unki u19 players ko lekar unki philosophy....
Ab yeh saaf saaf clear toh tha ki ab India ko consistently matches jeetne padege but for Rahul Dravid it was never about results...unka clear cut maan na tha ki Players ko rather than making them focus on results...jitna unhe competitive stages pe experience milega utna unke liye benefitial hai. Be it a loss or be it a win....Squad ke har ek player ko rotation mein use kara jaaega aur sabhi players apna best dena hoga.

So the message was clear : *'Winning the World Cup is important, but becoming future-ready is everything.'*

Aur isi sab ko Dravid ne apne us campaign ke dauran ek interview mein bhi bataya hai.

Lekin kise pata tha ki yeh experience oriented approach India ko unka most dominant U19 world cup campaign de degi.

<u>Chapter 2 : The Tournament of Domination</u>

(Visuals: Match highlights, Gill's elegant drives, Shaw's captaincy, Nagarkoti & Mavi's express pace, Kalra's heroics)

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Pura cricketing world Newzealand mein aajta hai toh win one single trophy , one single cup !
Ab bas yaha se 16 teams aur 48 matches ka intezaar tha untill hame ek naya U19 World champion milti.

Aur INDIA ko is tournament ko dominate karne ki journey shuru hoti hai 14 January 2018 ko jab woh apne pehle hi match mein Australia u19 ko face karte hai. Us Match mein India ke future stars like Shubman Gill , Abhishek Sharma , Pirthwi Shaw , Kamlesh Nagarkoti aur us tournament ke best batsman and bowler Manjot Kalra aur Anukul roy bhi khel rahe the. Toh is playing Xi se aap andaza laga sakte ho ki us match ka kya haal raha hoga. India toss jeet ti hai aur batting karne ka decide karti hai. Aur pehli ball se hame dikh jata hai ki Rahul Dravid ke players kitne jyada fearless ban chuke hai. Sabse pehle Pirthwi Shaw and Manjot Kalra ki 180 runs ki opening partnership....phir Shubman Gill ki lagai gai ek quick 50 aur score 328 tak jaa chuka tha. Iske jawab mein chase karne aayi Australia na keval humilate hui balki sapne 42.5 overs mein all out hoke us match 100 runs se haar gayi !

Kise ne bhi nahi socha tha ki jo team last u19 wc tak hardly 300 score kar paa rahi thi woh opening match mein 328 score kar degi. Is match ke highest wicket taker bante hai Kamlesh Nagarkoti and Shivam Mavi , jo ki 3-3 wickets lete hai.

Bas phir kya tha...next match mein ZImbabwe ko 1st innings mein 117 pe all out aur next match Papa new guinea ko mahez 64 pe all out kar India apne dono matches comfortably jeet jati hai aur table ke top pe jagah bana leti hai.

But tab tak title confirm nahi tha kyuki abhi knockouts aane baaki the and ham sabhi ko pata hai ki decade mein India ka knockouts mein kya haal chal raha tha phir chahe woh Mens ki senior team ho ya phir U19 wali team.....

Lekin aisa hua hota toh shayad hum aaj us dominating campaign pe video na bana rahe hote.

India ka Quarter Final match tha against Bangladesh.
Ab woh match apna aap mein itna kuch khaas nahi tha, infact India ne to us comfortably 71 runs se jeetkar apni jagah Semi finals mein bana li thi. But jo cheez mazedaar thi woh thi Shubman Gill ki 102 runs ki ek not out paari aur woh unki is tournament ki pehli century thi.
But lekin phir aata hai is pure world cup ka sabse anticipated match, the eternal rivalry INDIA VS PAKISTAN !
Aur keval koi aisa vaisa match nahi balki is tournament ka semi final tha. Yaani agar India haari toh na keval unhe Pakistan se haar ka backlash face karna padega balki woh is world cup se bhi bahar ho jaegi.

Pakistan toss jeeti ti hai aur India ko ek difficult surface pe India ko batting karne ka invitation deti hai. Lekin us difficult surface pe Gill tab bhi khade rehte hai aur ek aur brilliant century banate hai. Jaha pe ek taraf India wickets kho rahi thi collapse ho raha tha, vahi pe Gill us puri inning ke backbone banke khade ho gaye the. Aur usi ke badaluat India 273 ka target Pakistan de pai.
And phir jo hame India ke bowlers masterclass dekhne ko mili hai woh honestly kisi ne bhi expect kara tha...be it fans or commentators...

Ishan Porel aur Shivam Mavi jahe pe ek taraf starting mein Pakistan ko pareshan karte hai vahi pe dusri taraf Anukul roy aur Shiva Singh Pakistan ke wickets lene lag jaate hai. Pakistan ki batting ka settle hona toh choodo, Pakistan keval 69 runs pe hi all out ho jati hai aur India 203 runs se is match ko jeet jati hai.

THE FINAL !
Ab finally woh time aa jata hai jiske liye puri Indian team and Rahul Dravid ne mahino se mehnat ki thi. World Cup ka Final!
Aur woh us world cup ki one of the competitive team Australia ke khilaf. Halanki India Australia ko ek baar group stages mein ek taraf hara chuki thi lekin Finals ka pressure kuch aur hi hota hai (jo ki 2023 wc mein dekh chuke the)....Aur sabhi fans ki dua thi ki India ab finals mein aake toh choke na kar jaye.

Australia toss jeet ti hai aur pehle batting karne ka decide karna ka galat decision le leti hai. Kyuki jaha pe ek taraf woh pitch puri dry thi, vahi pe dusri taraf open cracks ki vajah se jis tarah Shivam Mavi Aussies ko pareshan karte hai woh dekhne layak tha. Shivam Mavi 3 wickets lete hai aur Australia mahex 216 pe all out ho jati hai. And phir begin hoti hai India ki chase ya phir aisa kaho ki Manjot Kalra ki chase .....
Prithwi Shaw ka wicket 71 pe khone ke baad Gill bhi 30 runs banake out ho jate hai lekin ek bhi baar aisa nahi lagta hai ki India might lose the match kyuki end ke dusre side khade the Manjot kalra jo ki ek ke baad ek boundires lagate jaa rahe the.....MANJOT KALRA us match mein notout 101 banate hai aur woh Match and world cup India ek dominating tarike se jeet jati hai !!!!!!!!!!

Is world cup ke top scorer the Shubman Gill jo ki aaj na keval Indian team ke test and odi captain hai balki modern cricket ka ek impt part ban chuke hai. Highest Wicket taker the Anukul roy with 14 wickets..

Us squad ki sabse khaas baat yeh thi ki us squad ke average playes bhi aaj T20I ke leading wicket taker for India [arshdeep] aur t20 ke ek ke baad ek records tod rahe hai..[Abhishek].....

Ab maano ya na maano cricket ne Prime West Indies se lekar Prime Australia tak sab dekha hai. Jinhone ICC trophies aur bilateral series ko jeetna ek normal routine ki tarah bana liya tha. And un sabhi teams mein generational players bhare pade hue the.